

Rachel S. Bailey, MUP

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Diana Searl-Chief Operating Officer
Highland Planning
Rochester, NY

Dear Chief Operating Officer Searl:

I am excited to apply for the Proposal Development Coordinator position with Highland Planning. With a Master of Urban Planning, professional experience in proposal and RFP/RFQ development, marketing communications, technical writing, project and program management, and a career that has included urban planning training, affordable housing, community development, and human services. I offer a combination of skills that align particularly well with this position. Just as importantly, I understand the work that Highland is pursuing and can help communicate that work clearly and persuasively to prospective clients.

My proposal and marketing communications experience includes positions with DeWolf Architects, Coombs Media, Xerox, and Northeast Hawley Development Association (NEHDA). At DeWolf Architects, I created and managed RFP/RFQ marketing collateral and worked with architects, graphic staff, contractors, and the media to communicate the firm's projects and support business development. At Coombs Media, I managed client marketing projects from concept through implementation, coordinating writers, graphic artists, vendors, schedules, and deliverables. As a Global Buyer for Marketing Communications at Xerox, I managed vendor relationships, analyzed marketing expenditures, negotiated contracts, and prepared reports and presentations for senior management. These experiences taught me how to bring together information from multiple contributors, organize it around a client's requirements, and move a polished deliverable from concept to completion under deadline.

My planning and community development background adds another dimension to what I would bring to Highland. I earned my Master of Urban Planning from the University at Buffalo with a specialization in Neighborhood and Community Development, with graduate work in land use, housing and community development, environmental planning, economic development, GIS, transportation, planning methods, and urban design. My professional experience has also included affordable housing development, construction project management, grant-funded program management, housing and homelessness programs, research, data analysis, stakeholder engagement, and public presentations. I therefore would not approach proposal coordination solely as an administrative or marketing function; I can understand the planning concepts, project objectives, community context, and technical information behind the proposals I am helping to develop.

Throughout my career, I have managed work that requires many of the same skills necessary for successful proposal development: coordinating people with different areas of expertise, tracking multiple requirements and deadlines, researching and synthesizing information, managing budgets and contracts, preparing written materials and presentations, and ensuring that final deliverables are accurate and responsive to requirements. I am comfortable moving between detailed technical information and clear, audience-focused communication.

Highland Planning particularly interests me because this position brings together areas that have been consistent throughout my career, planning, communications, writing, project coordination, and community-focused work. I would welcome the opportunity to use that combination of experience to help Highland develop compelling proposals and qualifications packages, strengthen business-development communications, and clearly demonstrate the value of the firm's work to municipalities, agencies, and community partners.

Thank you for considering my application. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my planning background, proposal and RFP/RFQ experience, marketing communications expertise, and project management skills could contribute to Highland Planning.

Sincerely,

Rachel S. Bailey, MUP